

TO SOLVE DIFFERENTIAL EQUATION USING
FROBENIUS METHOD.

Find a regular singular point of the following differential equation.

(a) $2x^2 \frac{d^2y}{dx^2} + 3x \frac{dy}{dx} + (x^2 - 4)y = 0$.

(b) $x^2(x-2)^2 y'' + 2(x-2)y' + (x+3)y = 0$,
solution.

(a), $\frac{d^2y}{dx^2} + \frac{3x}{2x^2} \frac{dy}{dx} + \frac{(x^2-4)}{2x^2} y = 0$.

$$P(x) = \frac{3x}{2x^2} = \frac{3}{2x} \quad Q(x) = \frac{x^2-4}{2x^2}$$

$$\phi(x) = 0.$$

$$\text{at } x=0.$$

$$P(0) = \infty \quad Q(0) = \infty \quad \phi(0) = 0.$$

The point $x=0$ is a regular singular point

Using Frobenius method.

Case 1. when roots λ_1 and λ_2 are distinct and not differing by integers.

$$\lambda_1 - \lambda_2 = 0 \text{ or}$$

$$\lambda_1 = \lambda_2 \quad \lambda_2 = 2.$$

$$\lambda_1 - \lambda_2 = \lambda_2 - 2 = -3/2.$$

The complete solution is given by

$$y(x) = c_1(y)\lambda_1 + c_2(y)\lambda_2$$

Case 2: When λ_1 and λ_2 are equal

$$\lambda_1 = \lambda_2$$

The complete solution is given by

$$y(x) = c_1(y)\lambda_1 + c_2\left(\frac{\partial y}{\partial \lambda}\right)\lambda_2$$

Case 3: When roots λ_1 and λ_2 are distinct and differ by integer ($\lambda_1 < \lambda_2$)

$$\lambda_1 = 3/2 \quad \lambda_2 = 5/2$$

$$\lambda_1 - \lambda_2 = 3/2 - 5/2 = -1$$

Example find the solution of the following differential equation,

$$3x \frac{d^2 y}{dx^2} + 2 \frac{dy}{dx} + y = 0 \quad \text{--- (i)}$$

Solution.

$$\frac{d^2 y}{dx^2} + \frac{2}{3x} \frac{dy}{dx} + \frac{1}{3x} y = 0$$

$$P(x) = \frac{2}{3x} \quad Q(x) = \frac{1}{3x} \quad \Phi(x) = 0$$

at $x = 0$,

$$P(0) = \infty \quad Q(0) = \infty \quad \Phi(0) = 0$$

The point is a regular singular point,

Step 2: let $y(x) = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} a_k x^{\lambda+k}$ ————— (2)

$$y'(x) = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} (\lambda+k) a_k x^{\lambda+k-1} \quad \text{————— (3)}$$

$$y''(x) = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} (\lambda+k)(\lambda+k-1) a_k x^{\lambda+k-2} \quad \text{————— (4)}$$

Step 3: Use (2), (3), and (4) in (1) to get:

$$3x \frac{d^2 y}{dx^2} + 2x \frac{dy}{dx} + y = 0$$

$$3x \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} (\lambda+k)(\lambda+k-1) a_k x^{\lambda+k-2} + 2 \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} (\lambda+k) a_k x^{\lambda+k-1} + \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} a_k x^{\lambda+k} = 0$$

$$\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} 3(\lambda+k)(\lambda+k-1) a_k x^{\lambda+k-1} + \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} 2(\lambda+k) a_k x^{\lambda+k-1} + \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} a_k x^{\lambda+k} = 0$$

Step 4: Equating the coefficient of x on L.H.S and R.H.S,
The indicial equation we put $k=0$,

$$\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} 3\lambda(\lambda-1) a_0 x^{\lambda-1} + \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} 2\lambda a_0 x^{\lambda-1} + \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} a_0 x^{\lambda} = 0$$

$$3a_0(\lambda-1)\lambda + 2\lambda a_0 = 0$$

$$(\lambda-1)\lambda + 2\lambda a_0 = 0$$

$$3\lambda^2 - 3\lambda + 2\lambda = 0.$$

$$\boxed{3\lambda^2 - \lambda = 0} \text{ — indicial equation.}$$

$$\lambda = 0 \text{ or } 3\lambda - 1 = 0.$$

$$\lambda_1 = 0 \text{ or } \lambda_2 = 1/3.$$

Step 5: To generate the general formula we put $k=1$.

$$\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} 3(\lambda+k)(\lambda+k-1) q_k x^{\lambda+k} + \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} 2(\lambda+k) q_k x^{\lambda+k-1} + \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} q_k x^{\lambda+k} = 0.$$

$$k = k+1$$

$$\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} 3(\lambda+k)(\lambda+k-1) q_k$$

$$\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} 3(\lambda+k+1)(\lambda+k) q_{k+1} x^{\lambda+k} + \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} 2(\lambda+k+1) q_{k+1} x^{\lambda+k} + \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} q_k x^{\lambda+k} = 0.$$

$$= 3 q_{k+1} (\lambda+k+1)(\lambda+k) + 2 q_{k+1} (\lambda+k+1) + q_k = 0.$$

$$\boxed{[3(\lambda+k+1)(\lambda+k) + 2(\lambda+k+1)] q_{k+1} + q_k = 0}$$

$$\boxed{q_{k+1} = \frac{-q_k}{(\lambda+k+1)(3(\lambda+k)+2)}}$$

$$k=0, \quad q_1 = \frac{-q_0}{(\lambda+1)(3\lambda+2)}.$$

$$K=1, \quad Q_2 =$$

$$= \frac{-Q_1}{(\lambda+2)(3\lambda+5)}.$$

$$\therefore Q_2 =$$

$$= \frac{Q_0}{(\lambda+1)(3\lambda+2)(\lambda+2)(3\lambda+5)}.$$

$$K=2.$$

$$Q_0 =$$

$$= \frac{-Q_3}{(\lambda+3)(3\lambda+8)}.$$

Now for $\lambda=0$, we have

$$Q_1 = -Q_0/2.$$

$$Q_2 = \frac{1}{20} Q_0.$$

$$Q_3 = -\frac{1}{480} Q_0.$$

$$y_1(x) = [Q_0 + Q_1 x + Q_2 x^2 + \dots] x^{\lambda_1}$$

$$y_1(x) = Q_0 \left(1 - \frac{1}{2}x + \frac{1}{20}x^2 + \dots \right) x^0$$

When $\lambda = \frac{1}{3}$ we get

$$Q_1 = -\frac{1}{4} Q_0.$$

$$Q_2 = \frac{1}{56} Q_0, \quad Q_3 = -\frac{1}{112} Q_0.$$

$$y_2(x) = [a_0 + a_1 x + a_2 x^2 + \dots] x^{\lambda_2}$$

$$y_2(x) = a_0 \left(1 - \frac{1}{4}x + \frac{1}{56}x^2 + \dots \right) x^{1/3}$$

$$y(x) = C_1 y_1(x) \lambda_1 + C_2 y_2(x) \lambda_2$$

$$y(x) = a_0 \left(1 - \frac{1}{2}x + \frac{1}{20}x^2 + \dots \right) + a_0 \left(1 - \frac{1}{4}x + \frac{1}{56}x^2 + \dots \right) x^{1/3}$$

